

PRE-CONFERENCE FIELD KIT



September 28 to October 1, 2026 • Gaylord National Resort
National Harbor, Maryland • Archway at booth 131

Everything here is on the list because at some point one of us learned it the hard way.

PACK AND PREP

- ☐ **Two pairs of comfortable shoes.** Rotate them. The Gaylord is enormous.
- ☐ **A light jacket.** Session rooms run cold. Every year, without fail.
- ☐ **A conference day bag.** Light, with a strap. You will collect swag.
- ☐ **A portable charger.** Your battery will be gone by two in the afternoon.
- ☐ **A refillable water bottle.** There are fill stations. Four days of bottles is a choice.
- ☐ **Extra business cards.** More than you think. People still run out.
- ☐ **A travel medicine kit.** Advil, Tums, throat lozenges. Four days of talking.
- ☐ **Blister bandages.** See the shoes. This is the item people thank us for.

LEARNING STRATEGY

- ☐ **Pick the sessions you cannot miss.** Skip the rest without guilt.
- ☐ **Sit up front and photograph the slides.** Faster than notes, easier to share.
- ☐ **Ask one question per session.** The cheapest way to meet a speaker.

PLAN AHEAD

- ☐ **Block your calendar now.** Email will find you in the sessions otherwise.
- ☐ **Download the Applied Net app.** Build your schedule in it before you fly.
- ☐ **Map the evening events first.** Double-booking happens at dinner.

NETWORKING PREP

- ☐ **Draft your pitch.** Twenty seconds on who you are and what your agency does.
- ☐ **Set three goals.** Five new agencies, two vendors worth a follow-up, one carrier.
- ☐ **Bring thank-you notes.** Paper beats a fourth follow-up email.

ON SITE AT THE GAYLORD

- ☐ **Budget the walk.** The exhibit hall and the session rooms are not close.
- ☐ **Eat before the hall opens.** Every atrium restaurant has a line at every meal.
- ☐ **Find your quiet corner on day one.** The atrium is beautiful and it is loud.
- ☐ **Book rides early.** National Harbor empties out all at once every evening.

Booth 131. Book twenty minutes and we will send you a \$100 Visa gift card.

First 50 meetings booked. Archway works exclusively with independent insurance agencies.

connect.myarchway.com/applied-net-meeting

